

11th EFSPI Regulatory Statistics Workshop

19 – 20 August 2026

Basel Switzerland

Day 0: 18th August 2026, 19:00-22:00

19:00 – 22:00 **Pre-Conference Regulatory Dinner**

All regulators and HTA assessors are cordially invited to this (self-paid) event, organized by Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE) and Heidi Mestl (SAWP member, NoMA, NO).

For more information and registration please visit <https://forms.gle/ihANxp8V3gUctCMu6>

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together)

Time	Presentation
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08:40 – 09:00	Housekeeping + Opening Remarks
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(5 + 15 min)

Anna Wiksten (EFSPI President, BMS, CH)

09:00 – 10:00	Short Topics 'reversed'.
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(60 min)

Regulators Question, Industry Answers: An Interactive Panel Session

A committee-selected set of pre-submitted questions is briefly introduced by regulators and then explored in a moderated panel discussion, where industry experts share their experience-based perspectives and practical insights in response.

Chairs: Lukas Aguirre Dávila (SAWP member, PEI, DE), Julie Jones (Novartis, CH)

Panelists: Cordula Zeller (Boehringer Ingelheim, DE), Evgeny Degtyarev (Novartis, CH), Hsin-Ju Hsieh (BMS, US), Marc Vandemeulebroecke (Bayer, CH), Natasha Mühlemann (Curie.Bio, CH), Randi Grøn (Novo Nordisk, DK)

Topic 1: John Aspegren with Tommi Nurminen and Elina Asikanius (fimea, FI):
On changes to ongoing open-label clinical trials

Topic 2: Armin Schöler (BfArM, DE):
One Scientific Question – Two discussions? Bridging the clinical–statistical divide

Topic 3: Laura Rodwell (Medicines Evaluation Board, NL):
Relationship status: It's complicated

10:00 – 10:30	Coffee break
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(30 min)

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together) <continued>

Time	Presentation
10:30 – 12:30 (120 min)	Short Topics. Engaging Regulators: Industry Questions and Regulatory Insight A committee-selected set of pre-submitted industry questions is briefly introduced and then discussed by a panel of regulators, who share interpretations based on existing guidance and current regulatory thinking. <i>Chairs:</i> Heidi Mestl (SAWP member, NoMA, NO), Patrick Schlömer (Bayer, DE) <i>Panelists:</i> (*MWP member, #SAWP member) Juan José Abellán Andrés (EMA, NL), Elina Asikanius** (fimea, FI), Lukas Aguirre Dávila#, Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE), Andreas Brandt, Armin Schöler (BfArM, DE), Khadija Rerhou Rantell (MHRA, UK), Laura Rodwell (MEB, NL), Rafael Sauter (Swissmedic, CH), Susanne Urach (AGES, AT) Topic 1: Diane Uschner (Roche, CH), Olga Kuznetsova (Merck), Johannes Krisam, Kerstine Carter (BI), and Alex Sverdlov (Novartis) on behalf of the Randomization SIG: Randomization in clinical trials – Statistical advancement and regulatory acceptance Topic 2: Achille Demares, Kelly Van Lancker, and Stijn Vansteelandt (Ghent University, BE), Hege Michiels, Els Coart, Fien Gistelinck, and Efi Gymnopoulou (argenx, BE): Delayed-Start Design: enabling placebo-controlled comparative analysis Topic 3: Tobias Mütze, Mouna Akacha, and Frank Bretz (Novartis, CH): Statistical details in the protocol: how much is enough? Topic 4: Baldur Magnusson (UCB, CH) and Marcel Wolbers (Bayer, CH) on behalf of all contributors (EFPIA/EFSPi EIWG estimation sub-team + many colleagues): Composite strategies for continuous endpoints: failure values or failed question? Topic 5: Martin Kappler (Cytel, FR) and Emmanuel Zuber (Cogitamen, CH): Conditional marketing authorization and testing strategy on a single pivotal trial – A call for consistency: is the Regulator open to base conditional approval on conditional results? Topic 6: Xin Luo (Pfizer, NO), Maria Kudela (Pfizer, US), and Margaret Gamalo (Pfizer, US): Real-time trials, unfinished rules: can we keep up with the science we invited?
12:30 – 14:00 (90 min)	Lunch break and poster session: ESIGs and EFSPi Working Groups

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together) <continued>

Time	Presentation
14:00 – 15:30 (90 min)	Global Regulatory Strategic Priorities: Key Updates and Discussion with Health Authorities This session provides concise updates on current regulatory strategic priorities and key developments from global health authorities, including EMA, FDA, and MHRA/Swissmedic, with a focus on topics most relevant to industry. The updates are followed by an interactive discussion, offering the audience an opportunity to engage directly with presenters through questions and dialogue. <i>Chairs:</i> <i>Andreas Brandt (BfArM, DE), Jenny Devenport (Merck KgaA, CH)</i> Talk 1: Greg Levin (FDA, US, virtual): Statistical updates from the United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) Center for Drug Evaluation and Research (CDER) Talk 2: Elina Asikanius (SAWP & MWP member, fimea, FI): CTR and NPL? Why do these acronyms matter and why should a statistician be aware of European legislation? Talk 3: Jasvinder Singh (MHRA, UK) Recent Developments - MHRA Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers, and the panelist: Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE).
15:30 – 16:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
16:00 – 17:30 (90 min)	Draft EMA Guideline on Non-Inferiority and Equivalence: Key Updates and Stakeholder Perspectives This session will summarize the key thinking behind the EMA draft guideline on non-inferiority and equivalence comparisons in clinical trials and the most important changes introduced. It will then examine and discuss selected stakeholder comments submitted during the public consultation, highlighting areas of consensus, concern, and potential impact on future practice. <i>Homework:</i> To get most out of the session, please read this EMA draft guideline on non-inferiority and equivalence comparisons in clinical trials. <i>Chairs:</i> <i>Anouk Neven (EMA, LU), Helle Lynggaard (Novo Nordisk, DK)</i> Talk 1: Susanne Urach (AGES, AT): Key changes in the draft guideline with potential impact on future practice and received public comments Talk 2: Tobias Mütze (Novartis, CH): Opportunities and challenges in the draft EMA non-inferiority guideline: a stakeholder perspective Q&A and discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: Florian Lasch (EMA, NL).
17:30 – 19:00	Apéro & Informal Networking – Enjoy light refreshments and drinks in a relaxed setting, and take the opportunity to continue conversations and connect with fellow participants.

BBS Next Gen is organizing an **informal, self-funded dinner** following the apéro.

Whether you are attending the workshop or simply looking to connect with colleagues and peers, they would be delighted to welcome you at KLARA, Clarastrasse 13, 4058 Basel (just a short walk from the Biozentrum) at 19:30 CEST for an enjoyable evening of networking and informal discussions.

Please RSVP [here](#) to confirm your attendance. Once registered, you will also have the option to add the event directly to your calendar.

Time	Presentation
09:00 – 10:30 (90 min)	Development of patient relevant and sensitive endpoints – opportunities for statisticians This session will address recent methodological developments in clinical endpoint selection and validation, with a focus on rare diseases and paediatric populations. Emphasis will be placed on the early involvement of statisticians in endpoint strategy, highlighting their role in disease-specific, patient-relevant, and sensitive outcome measure development, as well as the value of regulatory qualification pathways and qualification opinions to support robust evidence generation in areas of high unmet need. <i>Chairs:</i> Elina Asikanius (SAWP & MWP member, fimec, FI), Claudia Dallinger (Boehringer Ingelheim, DE) Talk 1: Susanne Clinch (Roche, UK): How to identify relevant disease domains in a heterogeneous, multi-domain syndrome? Measuring what matters: a case study from Angelman syndrome Talk 2: Laurent Servais (Professor of Paediatric Neuromuscular Diseases, University of Oxford, UK): Stride velocity 95th centile (SV95C): From EMA qualification in Duchenne to the application in 26 other conditions Talk 3: Taco B.M. Monster (Medicines Evaluation Board, NL): Regulatory view on qualification of novel endpoints What are the advantages of the qualification procedure in the validation process of novel endpoints? Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: Jan Lucca Bilek (G-BA, DE).
10:30 – 11:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
11:00 – 12:30 (90 min)	From first wave to future practice: learning from early Joint Clinical Assessments procedures During the summer, publication of the first European Joint Clinical Assessment (JCA) reports is expected. As the JCA process is new, it comes with methodological and procedural challenges for all stakeholders involved (particularly in the context of rare diseases). This session will serve to share experiences from the first JCAs including core methodological challenges, PICO selection, the appraisal of indirect treatment comparisons, and characterisation of uncertainty. Attendees will gain insights into how these issues are being interpreted within the evolving EU HTA framework from different angles. <i>Chairs:</i> Seamus Kent (ESHPM, NL), Katrin Kupas (Merck KgaA, CH) Talk 1: Antje Behring (Leonardo Symphony, DE): From PICO to assessment report: how HTA bodies navigate uncertainty, evidence gaps and diverging perspectives Talk 2: Lars Beckmann (IQWiG, DE): Experiences from the first JCAs with some clarifications on data presentation, indirect comparisons and risk of bias assessment Talk 3: Thomas Ecker (Ecker + Ecker, DE): Navigating JCA – Where are we at month 20? Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience and the speakers.
12:30 – 14:00 (90 min)	Lunch break

Time	Presentation
14:00 – 15:30 (90 min)	Aligned at Baseline? Closing the Gaps on Baseline Covariate Adjustment Adjusting for prognostic baseline covariates is a powerful tool for improving statistical efficiency in treatment effect estimation. But are industry and regulators fully aligned on its application? This session aims to close the gaps in current practice by: • Facilitating a candid dialogue between industry experts and regulators. • Clarifying current expectations and addressing perceived inconsistencies. • Fostering a shared, unified understanding of appropriate covariate adjustment strategies. <i>Chairs:</i> Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE), Vivian Lanius (Boehringer Ingelheim, DE) Talk 1: Dominic Magirr (Novartis, CH): Covariate adjustment in RCTs: translating fundamental principles into practice Talk 2: Robin Ristl (Medical University of Vienna, AT): Regulatory perspectives on covariate adjustment in randomized trials Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: Seamus Kent (ESHPM, NL).
15:30 – 16:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
16:00 – 17:30 (90 min)	Synthetic Data in Biostatistics: Definitions, Regulatory Implications, and Practical Applications This session examines what is meant by <i>synthetic data</i> in the context of drug development, including key definitions, methodological approaches, and intended use cases. It further discusses the scientific, regulatory, and practical consequences of using synthetic data, highlighting opportunities, limitations, and implications for decision-making across development programs. <i>Chairs:</i> Khadija Rantell (MHRA, UK), Pierre Mancini (Sanofi, FR) Fireside chat: What's New About Synthetic Data? Promise, Hype, and Practical Reality A conversation with Professors Theresa Stadler (Swiss Data Science Center, CH) and Matthias Templ (Fachhochschule Nordwestschweiz, CH) exploring what synthetic data is, what is genuinely new about contemporary synthetic data approaches, and where they may – or may not – deliver meaningful value in drug development research and decision-making. Talk: Andrea Manfrin (MHRA, UK) and Federico Mattiello, Francesco Brizzi (Roche, CH): Use of synthetic data in clinical trials: a stakeholder's journey to overcome limitations of standard clinical trials Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelists: Kit Roes (Chair EMA Methodology Working Party, Radboud University, NL) and Lukas Aguirre Dávila (SAWP member, PEI, DE).
17:30 – 17:40	Closure Vivian Lanius (Boehringer Ingelheim, Organizing and Scientific Committee, DE)

Poster session of ESIGs and EFSPi Working Groups on Day 1 (19th August 2026, 12:30 – 14:00)

ESIG/EFSPi Working Group	Title	Presenter(s) / Co-author(s) on behalf of the respective ESIG/EFSPi WG
BBS Next Gen Committee	Shape the next generation of quantitative scientists	<i>Robbie Peck</i>
Early Phase ESIG	New ESIG on the Block! Introducing the Early Phase ESIG	<i>Nicolas Sauvageot, Samantha Hinsley (Chair), Marie-Karelle Riviere (Co-Chair)</i>
Estimand Implementation Working Group – Reporting Subteam	Estimand implementation in the EU Clinical Trial Register CTIS: are we there yet?	<i>Ulrike Fischer, Karen Muhs, Edith Küpper, R. Maarten van Dijk (all Staburo)</i>
HTA SIG	Working together to shape the future of evidence for HTA and JCA	<i>Arthur Allignol, Orlando Dohring, Min-Hua Jen, Annett Kucka, Sutish Kumar, Katrin Kupas</i>
HTA & RWD SIG	Synthetic data for HTA and real-world evidence: overcoming data constraints in evidence generation	<i>Orlando Dohring, Rima Izem, Min-Hua Jen, Iftekhar Khan, Annett Kucka, Josephine Wolfram</i>
Launch and Lifecycle SIG	Launch & Lifecycle eSIG	<i>Cornelia Dunger-Baldauf</i>
Medical Devices SIG	Statistical challenges and regulatory landscape in medical device development: the EFSPi/PSI Special Interest Group Medical Devices	<i>Michael Mader, Wilmar Igl, Martin Fahy, Emilie Gérard, Rada Đakovic</i>
Multi-Component Endpoints SIG	EFSPi/PSI Multi-component endpoints SIG	<i>Alex Ocampo, Nuala Peter, Patrick Schlömer, Vivian Lanius</i>
Randomization SIG	Randomization Working Group – Bridging statistical innovation and clinical trial practice	<i>Diane Uschner</i>
Regulatory SIG	EFSPi/PSI Regulatory European Special Interest Group (ESIG)	<i>Fredrik Öhrn, Christoph Gerlinger</i>
RWD SIG	EFSPi/PSI Real World Data SIG	<i>Josie Wolfram, Eleanor Ralphs, Rima Izem</i>